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Git Help

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Why and When to Use Git Help?

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Git has many commands and options.

If you forget how a command works or want to learn about its options, you can use Git's built-in help.

This is the fastest way to get answers without leaving your terminal.

Change Platform:
GitHub
Bitbucket
GitLab

Key Commands for Getting Help

- `git help <command>` - See the manual page for a command
- `git <command> --help` - See help for a command (same as above)
- `git <command> -h` - See a quick summary of options
- `git help --all` - List all possible Git commands

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See Help for a Specific Command (`git help <command>`)

Shows the full manual page for a specific command, including all options and examples:

Example: See Help for Commit

```
[user@localhost] $ git help commit
GIT-COMMIT(1)
NAME
    git-commit - Record changes to the repository
SYNOPSIS
    git commit [options] [--] ...
DESCRIPTION
    Stores the current contents of the index in a new c
    together with a log message from the user describir
...
```

This command opens the full documentation for `git commit` in your terminal.

Tip: While viewing help pages:

- Use the **arrow keys** or `Space` to scroll down, `b` to scroll up.
- Type `/` followed by a word to search (e.g., `/option`), then `n` for next match.
- Press `q` at any time to quit the help view.

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This does the same as `git help <command>`. Most users prefer this form:

Example: See Help for Status

```
[user@localhost] $ git status --help
GIT-STATUS(1)
NAME
    git-status - Show the working tree status
SYNOPSIS
    git status [options] [--] [pathspec...]
DESCRIPTION
    Displays paths that have differences between the ir
...
```

This command opens the manual page for `git status`.

See a Quick Summary with -h (`git <command> -h`)

Shows a short summary of the command's options, right in the terminal window (does not open the full manual):

Example: Quick Help for Add

```
[user@localhost] $ git add -h
usage: git add [options] [--] ...
    -n, --dry-run         dry run
    -v, --verbose         be verbose
    -i, --interactive     interactive picking
    -p, --patch           select hunks interactively
```

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This command gives you a brief overview of available options for a command.

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List All Git Commands (`git help --all`)

Lists every Git command available on your system, grouped by category:

Warning: This will display a very long list of commands

Example

```
[user@localhost] $ $ git help --all
See 'git help ' to read about a specific subcommand
```

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```
   archive          Create an archive of files from
   bisect           Use binary search to find the c
   branch           List, create, or delete branche
   bundle           Move objects and refs by archiv
   checkout         Switch branches or restore work
   cherry-pick      Apply the changes introduced by
   citool           Graphical alternative to git-cc
   clean            Remove untracked files from the
   clone            Clone a repository into a new d
   commit           Record changes to the repositor
   describe         Give an object a human readable
   diff             Show changes between commits, c
   fetch            Download objects and refs from
   format-patch     Prepare patches for e-mail subm
   gc               Cleanup unnecessary files and c
   gitk             The Git repository browser
   grep             Print lines matching a pattern
   gui              A portable graphical interface
   init             Create an empty Git repository
   log              Show commit logs
   maintenance      Run tasks to optimize Git repos
   merge            Join two or more development hi
   mv               Move or rename a file, a direct
   notes            Add or inspect object notes
   pull             Fetch from and integrate with a
   push             Update remote refs along with a
   range-diff       Compare two commit ranges (e.g.
   rebase           Reapply commits on top of anoth
   reset            Reset current HEAD to the speci
   restore          Restore working tree files
   revert           Revert some existing commits
   rm               Remove files from the working t
   shortlog         Summarize 'git log' output
   show             Show various types of objects
   sparse-checkout  Initialize and modify the spars
   stash            Stash the changes in a dirty wo
```

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```
   worktree            Manage multiple working trees

Ancillary Commands / Manipulators
   config              Get and set repository or globa
   fast-export         Git data exporter
   fast-import         Backend for fast Git data impor
   filter-branch       Rewrite branches
   mergetool           Run merge conflict resolution t
   pack-refs           Pack heads and tags for efficie
   prune               Prune all unreachable objects f
   reflog              Manage reflog information
   remote              Manage set of tracked repositor
   repack              Pack unpacked objects in a repo
   replace             Create, list, delete refs to re

Ancillary Commands / Interrogators
   annotate            Annotate file lines with commit
   blame               Show what revision and author l
   bugreport           Collect information for user to
   count-objects       Count unpacked number of object
   difftool            Show changes using common diff
   fsck                Verifies the connectivity and v
   gitweb              Git web interface (web fronteno
   help                Display help information about
   instaweb            Instantly browse your working r
   merge-tree          Show three-way merge without to
   rerere              Reuse recorded resolution of co
   show-branch         Show branches and their commits
   verify-commit       Check the GPG signature of comm
   verify-tag          Check the GPG signature of tags
   whatchanged         Show logs with difference each

Interacting with Others
   archimport          Import a GNU Arch repository ir
   cvsexportcommit     Export a single commit to a CVS
   cvsimport           Salvage your data out of anothe
```

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```
   request-pull          Generates a summary of pending
   send-email            Send a collection of patches as
   svn                   Bidirectional operation betweer

Low-level Commands / Manipulators
   apply                 Apply a patch to files and/or t
   checkout-index        Copy files from the index to th
   commit-graph          Write and verify Git commit-gra
   commit-tree           Create a new commit object
   hash-object           Compute object ID and optionall
   index-pack            Build pack index file for an ex
   merge-file            Run a three-way file merge
   merge-index           Run a merge for files needing m
   mktag                 Creates a tag object
   mktree                Build a tree-object from ls-tre
   multi-pack-index      Write and verify multi-pack-inc
   pack-objects          Create a packed archive of obje
   prune-packed          Remove extra objects that are a
   read-tree             Reads tree information into the
   symbolic-ref          Read, modify and delete symboli
   unpack-objects        Unpack objects from a packed ar
   update-index          Register file contents in the w
   update-ref            Update the object name stored i
   write-tree            Create a tree object from the c

Low-level Commands / Interrogators
   cat-file              Provide content or type and siz
   cherry                Find commits yet to be applied
   diff-files            Compares files in the working t
   diff-index            Compare a tree to the working t
   diff-tree             Compares the content and mode c
   for-each-ref          Output information on each ref
   for-each-repo         Run a Git command on a list of
   get-tar-commit-id     Extract commit ID from an archi
   ls-files              Show information about files ir
   ls-remote             List references in a remote rep
```

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```
   rev-list             Lists commit objects in reverse
   rev-parse            Pick out and massage parameters
   show-index           Show packed archive index
   show-ref             List references in a local repo
   unpack-file          Creates a temporary file with a
   var                  Show a Git logical variable
   verify-pack          Validate packed Git archive fil

Low-level Commands / Syncing Repositories
   daemon               A really simple server for Git
   fetch-pack           Receive missing objects from an
   http-backend         Server side implementation of G
   send-pack            Push objects over Git protocol
   update-server-info   Update auxiliary info file to h

Low-level Commands / Internal Helpers
   check-attr           Display gitattributes informati
   check-ignore         Debug gitignore / exclude files
   check-mailmap        Show canonical names and email
   check-ref-format     Ensures that a reference name i
   column               Display data in columns
   credential           Retrieve and store user credent
   credential-cache     Helper to temporarily store pas
   credential-store     Helper to store credentials on
   fmt-merge-msg        Produce a merge commit message
   interpret-trailers   Add or parse structured informa
   mailinfo             Extracts patch and authorship f
   mailsplit            Simple UNIX mbox splitter progr
   merge-one-file       The standard helper program to
   patch-id             Compute unique ID for a patch
   sh-i18n              Git's i18n setup code for shell
   sh-setup             Common Git shell script setup c
   stripspace           Remove unnecessary whitespace

External commands
   askyesno
```

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Note: If you find yourself stuck in the list view, `SHIFT + G` to jump the end of the list, then `q` to exit the view.

List Guides and Concepts (`git help -g`)

Shows a list of guides and concept topics for deeper learning:

Example: List Guides and Concepts

```
[user@localhost] $ git help -g
The common Git guides are:
   attributes   Defining attributes per path
   everyday     Everyday Git With 20 Commands Or So
   glossary     A Git glossary of terms
   revisions    Specifying revisions and ranges for Git
...
```

This command is great for learning about Git's advanced concepts and best practices.

Troubleshooting

- **How do I quit the help viewer?** Press q to exit the help page.
- **Help page won't open?** Try `git <command> -h` for a quick summary instead.

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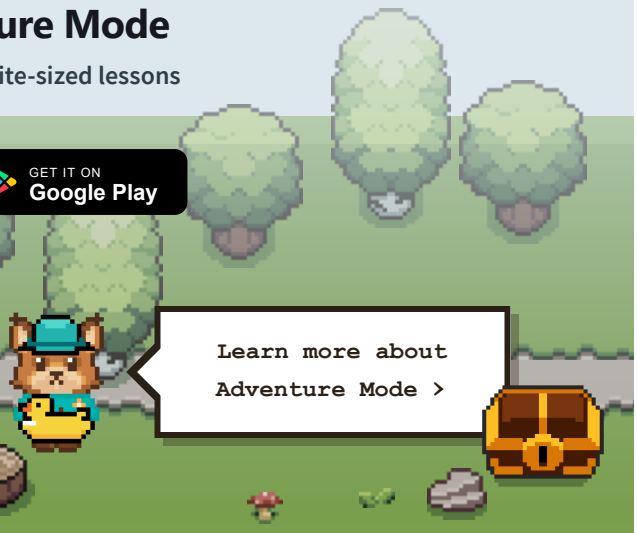
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